
MICROPROSE · 1994 · MS-DOS

Sid Meier's COLONIZATION



Technical Reference

The shipped MS-DOS release, documented from its binaries and data files. Executables and overlay architecture · asset containers · terrain and the map compositor · colonies, market, and the native economy · units, movement, and combat · powers, diplomacy, and revolution · events and strings · the UI engine, screen by screen · the map editor · data structures.

RECONSTRUCTED BY DISASSEMBLY OF VICEROY.EXE AND MAPEDIT.EXE · EVERY FIGURE TRACED TO A FILE OFFSET, A DATA-FILE FIELD, OR LIVE GAME MEMORY — OR MARKED UNMAPPED

Contents

The shipped 1994 MS-DOS release, documented from its binaries and data files. Facts in this volume were established by disassembly of the shipped executables, by reads of live game memory under emulation, and by pixel-level comparison of screens reconstructed from these pages against the running game. Where a value could not be established it is marked unmapped or runtime — no figure in this volume is invented.

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PART V

Politics and powers

§19 Natives

§19 Natives

Eight tribes populate the map with individually tracked villages. This chapter covers the whole native system in one place: the variables first, then every interaction in play order — meeting a tribe, entering its villages, trading, anger and alarm, missions, demands and hired wars, raids, and finally attacking and burning settlements. Everything here traces to the shipped binary or the original manual; where the binary has not yet given up a number, the item says so plainly (TBD) instead of guessing.

19.1 The native state model — every variable

The engine keeps native state in three layers:

1. **One record per tribe** (eight live records) — the tribe's advancement level, its life/death status, its trade stocks, and the per-power anger seed rolled at map generation.
2. **One 18-byte record per village** (up to 84, live count in `game.settlement_count`) — position, owner, population, mission, trespass memory, trade memory, and a per-European-power **alarm** word.
3. **A per-(tribe, power) tension table** — a 0..100 anger meter read through `get_tension()` and written only by the single applier `adjust_tension()`.

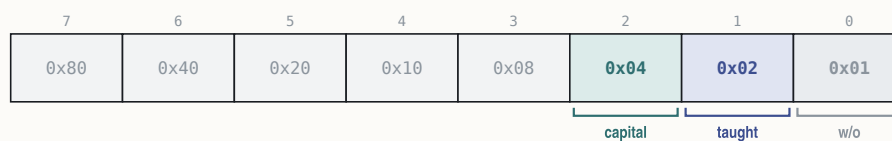
While a native event is being processed the engine keeps four context variables current: the active settlement record, the active tribe record, the tribe's index, and the tribe's power id (always the tribe index + 4).

settlement — the record's variables

storage layout in Appendix A - binding in Appendix C

VARIABLE	EXAMPLE	MEANING
<code>settlement.map_x</code>	23, 41	tile position
<code>settlement.map_y</code>	↑	
<code>settlement.owner</code>	7 = Iroquois	power id 4..11 = tribe index + 4
<code>settlement.flags</code>	4 = capital	0x04 capital; 0x02 taught; 0x01 write-only bit
<code>settlement.population</code>	8	village size — the raze-payout input (2026-05-30 ruling)
<code>settlement.mission</code>	255 = no mission	0xFF none; low nibble owner; 0x10 expert (Brébeuf)
<code>settlement.trespass</code>	2 incidents	escalation memory: set on trespass, bumped by trade
<code>settlement.last_bought</code>	2 = Tobacco	cargo id of the last good bought here
<code>settlement.last_sold</code>	255	write-only (initialised, never read)
<code>settlement.alarm[4]</code>	England 40 · France 12 · Spain 0 · Neth. 5	per-power anger words — war and raids at 128+

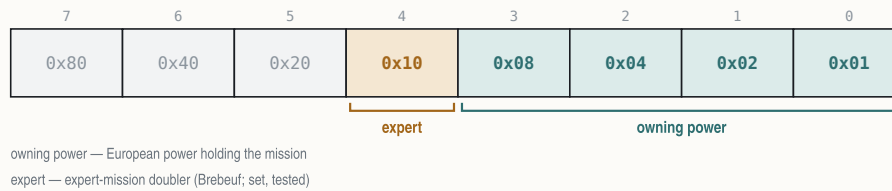
settlement.flags



capital — set; doubles value
 taught — already taught
 w/o — write-only bit

settlement.mission

255 = no mission



tribe — the record's variables

storage layout in Appendix A - binding in Appendix C

VARIABLE	EXAMPLE	MEANING
<code>tribe.level</code>	2 = Advanced (Aztecs)	tech level 0..3 — the camp/village/city class
<code>tribe.status</code>	128 = tribe wiped out	bit 0x80 = tribe wiped out
<code>tribe.muskets_known</code>	5	haggle: musket sell price scales on 12 - this
<code>tribe.horses_known</code>	3	haggle: horse sell price scales on 10 - this
<code>tribe.horses_stock</code>	40	village-supply model input
<code>tribe.silver_stock</code>	120	village-supply model input
<code>tribe.goods_stock[16]</code>	Furs 60 · Tobacco 25...	per-good stock folded into supply/demand
<code>tribe.alarm_seed[4]</code>	England 13 · France 6 · Spain 9 · Neth. 4	per-power starting anger, rolled at map creation

The two anger meters. They are separate and both matter:

- `settlement.alarm[power]` — a per-village word. At **128 or more** the village is on a war footing toward that power: it becomes a raid source and poisons colony-site desirability. This is also the number the village-entry code uses to swap *Trade With Village* for *Enter Hostile Village* at 75.
- `tension(tribe, power)` — the 0..100 tribe-level meter. **75 and above is hostile; 100 is war**. Every change goes through `adjust_tension()`, which clamps the result to 0..100 and **halves every positive (angering) delta** for France and for any power that has **Pocahontas** in Congress. (The applicer's fourth "category" argument is passed by all 33 callers and read by none — it is dead.)

The visible **attitude phrase** (Content / Uneasy / Restless / Angry, dressed with Extremely / Very / Rather / Somewhat / Slightly) is a display banding of a colonial-presence score at cutoffs −5 / 0 / 10; *War* is the separate alarm ≥ 128 state. The presence score's exact composition is multi-term and not fully decomposed — TBD.

Data-model corrections carried by this chapter: byte 6 of the village record is dead (the "growth counter" gloss in Appendix A.7 is stale), the alarm block is four 16-bit words (not byte pairs), and the old "visited"/"event-eligible" flag labels are withdrawn — no instruction sets or tests them.

19.2 The eight tribes

Tribe identity loads from NAMES.TXT `@TRIBES` at game start. The **color** column is the tribe's palette index — the tint of its orders boxes and map markings, exactly parallel to the European powers' colors (England 12, France 9, Spain 14, Netherlands 13) per the 2026-08-01 ruling. The **settlement** column shows the map art each tribe's class draws: camps for semi-nomadic tribes, long-houses for agrarian villages, and the two unique city sets; a tribe's **capital** carries a golden star overlay on the same art. (The art classes are hand-verified from the shipped sheets; the exact code site that selects the frame per tribe is not yet traced — TBD.)

ID	TRIBE	CLASS	GIFT GOOD	COLOR	SETTLEMENT
4	Incas	3 — Civilized (Cities)	Jewelled Relics	97	 Inca city

ID	TRIBE	CLASS	GIFT GOOD	COLOR	SETTLEMENT
5	Aztecs	2 — Advanced (Cities)	Gold Bars	149	 Aztec city
6	Arawaks	1 — Agrarian (Villages)	Bone Jewelry	54	 village
7	Iroquois	1 — Agrarian (Villages)	Wood Carvings	87	 village
8	Cherokee	1 — Agrarian (Villages)	Turquoise	67	 village
9	Apache	0 — Semi-Nomadic (Camps)	Beads	111	 camp
10	Sioux	0 — Semi-Nomadic (Camps)	Beads	118	 camp
11	Tupi	0 — Semi-Nomadic (Camps)	Gems	71	 camp

Capital overlay:  — the golden star drawn over the settlement art on each tribe's one capital.

The id column is the village record's `settlement.owner` value — tribe index plus 4, a convention both the destroy path and the display path agree on. `@TRIBES` continues with eighteen reserve, name-only tribes that never instantiate (Maya, Toltecs, Kiowa, Hurons, Hopi, Navajo, Cheyenne, Cree, Algonquin, Powhatan, Delaware, Shawnee, Illinois, Chickasaw, Choctaw, Seminole, Mohicans, Zapotec). The class row "Capital" in `NAMES @LEVELS` is a settlement *type*, not a fifth tech level.

When a native speaks, the dialog portrait sheet is chosen by name — `IND<tribe><pose>` — via `pick_native_portrait()`: the speaker channel holds the tribe index (values above 7 switch to the King's portraits), and the pose digit is a banding of the tribe's current tension toward the viewing power (the banding helper's exact cut points are unresolved — TBD).

19.3 First contact

First contact, start to finish

`native_events()`

- 1 **Meet on land** — ships and wagons are refused — “We must contact the Indians on land first, Excellency.”
- 2 **The woodcut plays, once ever** — Inca → THE INCA NATION · Aztec → THE AZTEC EMPIRE · all others → MEETING THE NATIVES.
- 3 **The treaty offer** — “We generously offer you the land you now occupy... live with us in peace as brothers?” — Yes / No.
- 4 **Yes — peace for now** — anger starts from the map-creation seed: $\text{random}(0..14) + 2 \cdot \text{difficulty}$ (human only), capped 20.
- 5 **No — war** — “Then the mighty {tribe} shall mercilessly drive you from our shores. Prepare for WAR!”

Greeting variants (worthy/ruthless tone) and a separate treaty text exist with untraced triggers `TBD`; no tribe-side “met” latch has been decoded

`TBD`.

The sheet above is the whole sequence; the treaty text and the woodcut titles are quoted verbatim from the game script.

The tribe's starting disposition was already fixed at map creation, when `place_native_settlements()` rolled each tribe's per-power anger seed:

starting anger(power) = random(0..14) + 2·difficulty

the +2·difficulty applies to HUMAN powers only; result saturates at 20

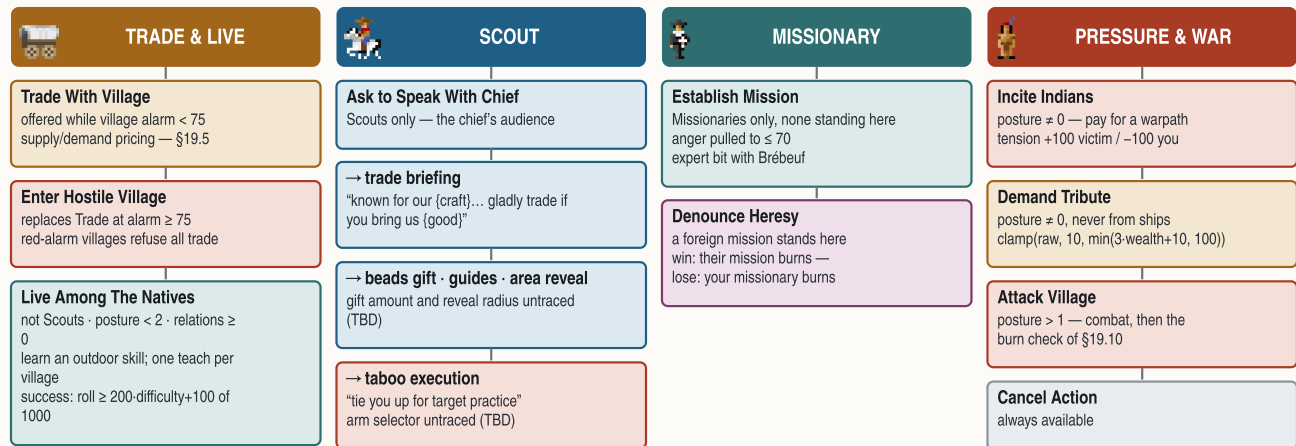
EXAMPLE at Conquistador (difficulty 2) a roll of 9 seeds the tribe's anger toward you at $9 + 4 = 13$; toward an AI rival the same roll stays 9

Two greeting variants (a *worthy* tone and a *ruthless* tone) and a separate treaty text exist in the game's script with no traced trigger — the condition that selects them is TBD. There is also **no tribe-side "met" latch** in the decoded state (the European powers keep one in their relation matrix); how the engine remembers a tribe has been met is untraced — TBD.

19.4 Entering a village — the ten actions

The village menu — four routes through ten actions

enter_village() · gates as decoded from the row-enable code



"Posture" is a traced-but-undecoded per-tribe state byte (TBD). Wagon trains that press an angry village vanish without a trace.

Moving a unit onto a village (first time: the *ENTERING INDIAN VILLAGE* woodcut, human players only) greets you with an attitude line — "Your expedition has reached a %s of {tribe}..." dressed as Happy / Medium / Savage / Bad / War — and opens the NAMES @ACTIONS menu. `enter_village()` is the only consumer of that menu; it enables rows like this:

#	ACTION	OFFERED WHEN
1	Trade With Village	village alarm toward you below 75
2	Enter Hostile Village	replaces Trade at alarm 75 and above
3	Establish Mission	unit is a Missionary and no mission stands here
4	Denounce Heresy of %F's Mission	a foreign power's mission stands here
5	Live Among The Natives	relations ≥ 0, tribe posture below 2, unit is not a Scout
6	Ask to Speak With Chief	unit is a Scout
7	Incite Indians	tribe posture nonzero
8	Demand Tribute	tribe posture nonzero, and the unit is not a ship
9	Attack Village	tribe posture above 1
10	Cancel Action	always

("Tribe posture" is a per-tribe state byte the gate code reads; its storage is traced but its semantic — likely a peace/war stance — is not yet decoded, TBD.) Angry villages turn traders away outright: ships get *"mad at ships"*, wagon trains get warned, then killed outright — *"Our wagon train has disappeared without a trace in {tribe} country."*

The chiefs audience (Scouts). Speaking with the chief runs through the same handler that later computes raze loot, `raze_settlement()`. Documented outcomes: the trade briefing (*"known for our {craft}. We would gladly trade if you bring us {good}..."* — built by sorting the village's live demand), the offer of **guides**, the **map-area reveal** ("tales of nearby lands"), the **beads gift** (*"Please take these valuable beads (worth {N})"*), a polite nothing, and — for taboo-breakers — *"You have broken sacred taboos... We shall tie you up for target practice."* Which arm fires is steered by a sub-mode argument whose selector is untraced (TBD); the beads amount and the reveal radius are likewise TBD. The manual warns a scout can die in the attempt, "influenced by the mood of the tribe" — no odds are traced.

Living among the natives (training). `live_among_natives()` teaches only outdoor skills — Expert Farmer, Fisherman, Fur Trapper, Silver Miner, the three Master Planters, Seasoned Scout. Petty Criminals are refused ("even the greatest teacher must have suitable material"), colonists who already master a profession are refused, and **each village teaches exactly once** — the grant writes the profession into the unit and stamps the village's already-taught flag. Unskilled colonists learn at once on a difficulty roll:

Learn succeeds when $\text{random}(1..1000) \geq 200 \cdot \text{difficulty} + 100$

= 90 / 70 / 50 / 30 / 10 % from Discoverer down to Viceroy

EXAMPLE at Explorer (difficulty 1) a Free Colonist needs 300+ on the thousand-roll — 70 % — otherwise "you must live among us longer" and may retry

Which skill a given village offers is stored nowhere that has been mapped — the per-settlement skill field is TBD.

19.5 Trading with a village

A trade session

`village_supply_demand()` · `haggle_trade()`

- ❶ **The village prices the moment** — demand & supply recomputed per good (§10 model); a capital doubles raw-goods demand and manufactured supply; "especially interested in..." = the sorted demand top.
- ❷ **You sell** — offer = $\max(1, (\text{seed} \cdot \text{demand} + 5 \cdot \text{mood}) \cdot \text{qty} / 100 / 2)$, seed = $2 \cdot (\text{base} - \text{difficulty} - \text{want} + \text{mood} + 4)$, mood = $\text{random}(1..5)$.
- ❸ **...or you buy** — ask = 200 (or $(8 - \text{level}) \cdot 50$ for horses and manufactures) + market term + $\text{random}(0..ask) - 4 \cdot \text{surplus} + 4 \cdot \text{tension}$, floor 50.
- ❹ **The haggle** — budget = $\text{random}(1..rounds) + \text{qty} / 4$, rounds = $\min(3, (\text{demand} - \text{want} + 4) / 10)$ — counter-offers until the budget runs dry.
- ❺ **Settle up** — gold moves 32-bit both ways · last-bought remembered · village wealth + 25 · tension − 4 goodwill.

Same visit: food-beg on a computed deficit, the corn gift on a fat surplus. The "let it be our gift" row's tension credit is untraced **TBD**; a village never buys the same good twice running (muskets excepted).

What the village wants is recomputed by `village_supply_demand()` — the full three-phase model (claimed-tile mask, 5×5 terrain scan, tribe-level supply and demand formulas) is documented in §10. Its outputs are two 16-good arrays, *demand* and *supply*, with two headline behaviours: a **capital doubles** its demand for raw goods (×1.5 for tools/muskets/trade goods) and doubles its supply of manufactures; and a village whose computed food demand outruns supply begs food from a visiting cargo (*"our people are hungry"*), while a fat surplus triggers the corn gift (*"accept this gift of corn"*). The chief's *"especially interested in..."* line names the top of the sorted demand list.

Selling. The village prices your cargo in one pass, then haggles:

```
sell offer = max( 1, ( max(0, seed·demand) + 5·mood ) · qty / 100 / 2 )
seed = 2·( base - difficulty - want + mood + 4 ), mood = random(1..5)
base is 6 for raw goods and 7 for manufactures, then per-good colour: Furs -random(0..7) ·
Muskets +(12 - tribe.muskets_known) · Horses +(10 - tribe.horses_known) · Trade Goods +1
want = the village's interest rank in the good, halved once its stock of it reaches 20,
forced to 0 for muskets and horses
```

EXAMPLE 100 Cloth to a village with demand-stock 10, mood 4, at Explorer: seed = $2 \cdot (7 - 1 - 2 + 4 + 4) = 24 \rightarrow (24 \cdot 10 + 20) \cdot 100 / 100 = 260 \rightarrow$ halved = 130 gold offered

```
haggle budget = random(1..rounds) + qty/4
```

```
rounds = min( 3, (demand - want + 4)/10 )
```

EXAMPLE demand-stock 10, want 2 $\rightarrow$ rounds = 1; selling 100 units gives a budget of $1 + 25 = 26$ — the village walks away when the budget is spent

Buying. The village prices its own goods the other way up:

```
buy price = max( 50, qty·ask/100 + ( difficulty + random(0..2) )·10 )
```

```
ask starts at 200 – for horses and manufactures it is (8 - tribe.level)·50 instead – then,
for silver and better: + market price · (2·difficulty + 15)
then + random(0..ask), - 4 · (village's surplus of the good), + 4 · (tribe's tension toward
you)
```

EXAMPLE 100 Horses from an Agrarian village (level 1): ask = 350, +34 market term, +200 rolled, -24 surplus, +52 tension = 612 $\rightarrow 612 + 20 = 632$ gold

A closed deal moves the gold through your treasury (`power.gold`, 32-bit both ways, with an honest can't-afford check), records the good in `settlement.last_bought`, adds 25 to the village's wealth word, bumps its trade counter — and credits **-4 goodwill** on the tribe's tension. The haggle script also carries a "*No, let the goods be our gift to you*" row; the gift's tension credit is untraced (TBD), though the original manual says gifts cool anger faster than sales. Two manual-attested behaviours round out the loop: a village will not buy the same good twice in a row (muskets excepted), and red-alarm villages refuse all trade.

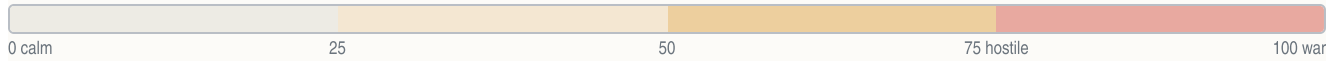
19.6 Alarm and anger — everything that raises and lowers it

The anger system on one sheet

`adjust_tension()` · `get_tension()`

TRIBE TENSION — 0..100, clamped every update

Content → Uneasy → Restless → Angry → Hostile → War



VILLAGE ALARM WORD — per village, per power

Calm → Trade → Hostile swap → Raids armed



HEATS

CAUSE	DELTA	NOTE
Drift, heating	+1	pressure counter crosses +8
Trespass, minor	+1	crossing tribal land
Trespass, moderate	+2	stamps village memory
Trespass, severe	+3	
Mission destroyed / expelled	+comp	amount TBD
Incite accepted vs you	+100	instant war footing
Burial-ground desecration	+100	the unit is executed
Ally's smite pact	+100	diplomacy row

COOLS

CAUSE	DELTA	NOTE
Drift, cooling	-1	quiet-turn credit
Normalization sweep	-1	decay loop over settlements
Successful trade	-4	goodwill after a closed deal
Mission founded	-comp	result capped at 70
Incite reward	-100	paid to the paying power
Pocahontas acquired	reset	all attitudes → Content

Both meters share one applier: positive deltas are halved for France and for a power that owns Pocahontas; results clamp 0..100. Scripted causes (roads, deforestation, missionaries, attacks, crowding) carry no traced delta **TBD**. Neighbour villages get clamped by a propagation tail whose semantics are undecoded **TBD**.

All tension changes flow through the single applier `adjust_tension()` — the sheet above is the complete traced ledger.

Beyond the tribe meter, each village's **alarm word** is what actually arms raids (threshold 128) and the Trade/Hostile menu swap (75). The applier's tail also **propagates alarm to neighbouring settlements of the same owner**, clamping their words to two fixed levels — the trigger and semantics of that clamp are still undecoded (TBD).

Six scripted anger notices (@PISS0..5) name the classic causes — road building, deforestation, foreign missionaries, unprovoked attacks, population pressure — but none carries a traced numeric delta (TBD). The original manual adds, at function level: colony size, building density and proximity raise alarm; muskets and cannon in a colony raise it; soldiers moved near a settlement raise it; a missionary working the settlement lowers it over time; everything is amplified when a capital is involved. The map shows the state as exclamation marks over the village, ramping pale green → blue → yellow → brown → red (a rival's alarm draws on that nation's colour).

At map generation each tribe also received the per-power **starting seed** of §19.3 — difficulty's only other finger on the scale is the attitude evaluator, which spots the human a harsher demand threshold than any AI.

19.7 Missions and conversion

The mission life cycle

`establish_mission()` · `attempt_conversion()` · `denounce_heresy()`

- 1 **Found it** — mission byte = your power · village anger pulled to ≤ 70 · expert bit with Brébeuf (retroactive when he joins) · map cross in your colour.
- 2 **Roll each eligible turn** — convert fires when $\text{random}(0..15) < \text{tribe.level} + 2$, doubled expert — an Indian Convert appears at your colony; unplaced converts die of lost faith after 8 turns.
- 3 **Congress tuning** — Sepúlveda +4 conversion metric · las Casas −4, and on acquire every Convert → Free Colonist.
- 4 **How missions end** — war-footing tribes burn missions (anger +computed, formula TBD) — or a rival denounces: their converts burn your mission, or your missionary burns at the stake (roll TBD).

Establish Mission (Missionaries only, one mission per village) writes the founding power into the village's mission byte — with the **expert bit** set when the founding power holds **Jean de Brébeuf** in Congress; acquiring Brébeuf later retroactively upgrades every mission you own. Founding also applies the anger *reduction* of §19.6 (capped so the meter lands at 70 or below), and the map marks the village with a cross in the owner's colour (the manual: a brighter cross for expert missions).

Each eligible turn the mission rolls for a convert via `attempt_conversion()`:

convert fires when $\text{random}(0..15) < \text{tribe.level} + 2$

the threshold doubles with Jean de Brébeuf

EXAMPLE an Aztec village (level 2) converts on 4 of the 16 roll values — one convert roughly every 4 turns; 8 of 16 with Brébeuf seated

A success spawns an **Indian Convert** at your colony (the colonist class that also enjoys the +1 staple bonus in the fields, §11). Converts that fail to join a colony within **eight turns** are eliminated "for loss of faith". Two Founding Fathers tune the pipeline: **Juan de Sepúlveda** adds +4 to the conversion metric; **Bartolomé de las Casas** subtracts 4 — and, on acquisition, upgrades every existing Convert to a Free Colonist. The per-turn scheduler (exactly when "each eligible turn" fires) is untraced — TBD.

Losing a mission hurts twice: the tribe's computed anger *increase* of §19.6, and the church's outrage — "*{tribe} burn {power} missions!*" — when a war-footing tribe torches them. *Denounce Heresy* against a rival's mission resolves to one of two endings — your denouncing power wins ("*converts burn the {rival} mission and erect a new, {yours} one!*") or loses ("*Loyal worshippers burn the {missionary} at the stake!*"); the win/lose roll is untraced (TBD; the manual ties it to the two powers' standing with the tribe).

19.8 Demands, tribute, and hired wars

You demand tribute. `demand_tribute()` derives an amount from the village's stores and clamps it:

tribute = clamp(raw, 10, min(3·village wealth + 10, 100))

EXAMPLE a village with wealth 12 yields at most $\text{min}(46, 100) = 46$ units of the good — and never less than 10 when it yields at all

Outcomes run from goods handed over, through "*our people are poor*", to the two refusals (laughter, or dark warnings). The raw pre-clamp derivation beyond "reads the settlement's stock" is TBD.

They demand from you. War-footing tribes press claims: reparations in gold ("The {tribe} people cry out for justice" — trigger and amount untraced, TBD), the contents of passing **wagon trains** (hand them over or circle the wagons), or goods straight from a colony's stores (man the stockade / hand them over). Land, road-building and deforestation objections arrive with a **buy-off row** — pay the named compensation and the tribe withdraws the objection ("Very well, we withdraw our objection."). **Peter Minuit** in Congress zeroes all land payments.

Incite. A unit in the village (posture permitting) can pay the tribe to take the warpath against a rival — "We will gladly drive the {rival} from our ancestral lands in exchange for {N}." Payment applies the +100/−100 tension pair of §19.6: the tribe goes to instant war footing against the victim and warms to you. The asking price's formula is untraced (TBD); the manual names its three factors — your missions with the tribe, their attitude toward you, and their attitude toward the target.

Hired wars, the other direction. In a European diplomacy meeting you can pay a rival power to "ruthlessly smite the heathen":

smite fee = clamp(factor · their treasury / 2500, 10, 200) · 50

halved when the hired power carries a certain attribute bit (meaning untraced)

EXAMPLE hiring a power with factor 6 while they hold 30 000 gold: $\text{clamp}(72, 10, 200) \cdot 50 = 3\,600$ gold — and they declare war on the tribe

And an AI ally busy "subduing the notorious heathen {tribe}" may ask *you* to join — accepting instantly sets that tribe's tension toward you to war footing (+100).

19.9 Raids

Raid resolution

native_raid() · scan_raid_targets()

1 · The gate — a village's alarm word reaches 128

a roll of random(1..12) − 1 fires the raid when it reaches $3 \cdot K + 1$

human bias the roll gains +(difficulty − 2) against a human colony · **K** untraced **TBD**

2 · Severity

random(1..4) — softened to a lower tier while turn < 40 · (2 − difficulty)

0 the raiding party is wiped out on the approach · **early game** the first decades pull their punches

3 · Dispatch

1 stores looted · 2 havoc wreaked · 3 gold stolen · 4 a building or ship burned

stores the village banks the haul · **payloads** beyond the messages **TBD** · **vs a human colony** the INDIAN RAID woodcut plays

The five outcomes and their message families:

ROLL	OUTCOME	MESSAGE FAMILY
wiped out	the raiding party dies on the approach	"raiding party wiped out"
1	stores looted — goods stolen from the colony; the village banks the haul	@RAIDSTORES
2	havoc wreaked in the colony	@RAIDWREAK

ROLL	OUTCOME	MESSAGE FAMILY
3	gold stolen	@RAIDGOLD
4	a building burned — or a ship in port burned	@RAIDBURN / @RAIDSHIP

The concrete payloads behind wreak/gold/burn/ship beyond their messages are unmapped (TBD). A raid against a human colony plays the *INDIAN RAID* woodcut. When native war parties win in the field the aftermath messages take over — colonies overrun or burned outright, units lost with muskets or horses seized (feeding the tribe's armament state), or your soldiers driving them off. The early-game downgrade above is why the first decades stay survivable on the easier difficulties.

19.10 Attacking a village — burn, loot, and extinction

Attack resolution

raze_settlement() · remove_settlement()

1 · Battle

a roll between 1 and ATK + DEF — the attacker wins if it lands at or below ATK

DEF defence bonus, doubled for a capital · village base defence formula TBD · manual cities >> villages >> camps

2 · Burn check — each victorious attack

a roll of random(0..100) — the village falls when hostility ÷ 4 stays at or below the roll

Seasoned Scout widens the roll to random(0..140) · size bias big villages re-roll the check upward · 75+ diverts to the big-treasure branch · population decrement not located in the binary TBD

3 · Raze gold — paid the moment the village falls

three dice added together × a roll of random(1..6) × 4 × (size + 1)

each die random(1 .. 10 – difficulty) · size the village population (2026-05-30 ruling) · capitals exceed the ceiling — bonus TBD

DIFFICULTY	DISCOVERER	EXPLORER	CONQUISTADOR	GOVERNOR	VICEROY
Raze gold ceiling (size 21)	15,120	13,608	12,096	10,584	9,072

- 1 March in — posture must allow war — “Shall we attack the {tribe}, Your Excellency?”
- 2 The battle — random(1..ATK+DEF) ≤ ATK wins.
- 3 Survive or burn — hostility/4 vs random(0..100).
- 4 Raze gold — straight to the treasury — no ×100, no Treasure unit on this path.
- 5 Aftermath — the last village falling wipes the tribe; a survivor’s wealth scales n/(n+1).

Each victorious attack re-runs steps 2–3; the sequence ends only when the burn check finally fails the village.

Worked example — a size-8 Iroquois village, Explorer difficulty, turn 96

BATTLE	attack 6 vs defence 3, random(1..9) rolls 4	4 ≤ 6, succeeds
BURN CHECK	hostility 38, random(0..100) rolls 52	38/4 = 9 ≤ 52, falls
RAZE GOLD	rolls 5+7+3 = 15, ×4, ×4, ×9	2,160 gold
AFTERMATH	Iroquois still hold 4 villages — no extinction	wealth × 4/5
TENSION	unprovoked attack heats the tribe	delta TBD

How many attacks until it burns? The honest state of the trace:

- Each victorious attack enters `raze_settlement()`, which fetches the village's hostility/size value and rolls the **survive-or-burn check**: `random(0 .. 100)` — widened to 140 by a **Seasoned Scout** attacker. Larger villages bias the check upward (the roll is re-rolled while value/4 still exceeds it), one tribe gets a difficulty-scaled special bound, and values of 75+ divert to a big-treasure branch.
- The **per-attack population decrement has not been located in the binary** — no instruction that lowers `settlement.population` on an attack has been found anywhere in the decoded image (TBD), and the exact wiring from the check to the destroy path is likewise untraced (TBD). What a closure needs: a DOSBox trace watching the population byte across repeated attacks. Until then: the *size* input below is the population per the 2026-05-30 ruling, and bigger populations demonstrably survive more attacks — but the decrement rule itself is not yet byte-verified.

The payout. When the village falls, the razing power collects gold on the spot:

The gold lands as a 32-bit credit in `power.gold` — **no ×100, and no Treasure unit on this path**. The *size* operand carries a documented conflict: the raw instruction reads the tribe's level byte, while the user-verified 2026-05-30 ruling identifies the true input as the village's population — the level read is the "Apache richer than Aztec" bug. Formula ceilings at size factor 21 run 15 120 / 13 608 / 12 096 / 10 584 / 9 072 from Discoverer to Viceroy — yet both captured **capital** razes exceed their ceiling, so a capital-only bonus exists whose magnitude is unmapped (TBD). The chief's execution scene ("*You have broken sacred taboos...*") is the scripted send-off. Treasure **units** — the wagons a Galleon hauls home — spawn only on the colony-combat path, with the King's cut on arrival governed by `cash_in_treasure()` (§18).

What the map does next. `remove_settlement()` retires the record: native units of the village are detached, the settlement table is compacted (every later record shifts down one slot, links repaired), the live count drops, and the tribe's settlement count falls. If it was the tribe's **last village**, the tribe's dead bit is set and "*The {tribe} tribe has been wiped out.*" announces the extinction; a surviving tribe instead has the removed village's wealth fields scaled down by $n/(n+1)$ — a correction of the older "spread across survivors" reading. (The debug menu's *Kill Indians* item drives exactly this machinery tribe-wide, greying out already-dead tribes.) Villages are born through `create_settlement()` — capped at 84 live records — and placed at map creation by `place_native_settlements()` from the dispersal chart.

19.11 Aside — plundering European colonies

For contrast with raze gold: capturing a **European** colony (the colony-combat path, disabled during the War of Independence) transfers a population-weighted share of the victim's whole treasury:

plunder = captured colony's population × victim's whole treasury ÷ victim's total colony population

EXAMPLE taking a population-6 colony from a power holding 3 000 gold across 20 total population: $6 \times 3000 \div 20 = 900$ gold

Natives never collect plunder this way — a native victory over a colony runs the burn/overflow messages of §19.9 instead.